

Employee Attrition: Key Findings & Recommendations

The Bottom Line

We looked at 1,470 employee records to understand who is leaving the company and why. About 16% of employees in this data left their jobs — and the reasons behind that turnover are clear, consistent, and something we can act on.

The 3 Biggest Warning Signs

1. **Overtime.** Employees working overtime leave at **30.5%**, versus just **10.4%** for those who don't — nearly 3x higher. This is the single strongest signal we found.
2. **Frequent business travel.** Employees who travel often for work are also much more likely to leave — a clear burnout and work-life balance issue.
3. **Early career stage.** Nearly **35%** of all departures happen within an employee's first year. New hires are, by far, our highest-risk group.

Who HR Should Prioritize

- **Sales Representatives** — 39.8% leave, the highest of any role — more than double the company average.
- **Sales department overall** — 20.6% attrition, the highest of any department.
- **Laboratory Technicians** — the single strongest individual risk factor identified in our model.
- **New hires (first 24 months)** — the highest-risk tenure window company-wide.

Note: Salary is a symptom, not the root cause. Employees who leave earn about 30% less on average, but pay ranks far below overtime, travel, role, and tenure as a predictor of who actually leaves. Raising pay alone won't fix retention.

What I Recommend

1. **Audit and cap overtime in Sales and Lab Technician teams.** Chronic overtime usually signals understaffing — fix it with hiring or workload redistribution, not policy alone.
2. **Build a structured “First 24 Months” retention program.** Add proactive check-ins at 90 days and 18 months for every new hire, and extend stock-option eligibility earlier — employees with zero stock options leave at **24.4%**, versus just **7–9%** for those with any equity.

One Important point

This analysis is based on a single historical snapshot of 1,470 employees, and our model correctly identifies an “at-risk” employee only about 1 in 3 times. It should be used to prioritize conversations and direct attention — not as a verdict on any individual — and should be revisited periodically as the workforce and policies change.